The Official MCU Film Slate

Volume 04 — locked in. **We use the real MCU film slate**: the same titles and release dates. The one structural change is **a new Phase One *Ant-Man* in 2009**, a year that had no MCU film in real life. Each film's story is still made 100% comic-accurate under Volumes 01 through 03.

The Ant-Man franchise is now four films: *Ant-Man* (2009, NEW) → *Ant-Man* (2015, film 2) → *Ant-Man and the Wasp* (2018, film 3) → *Ant-Man and the Wasp: Quantumania* (2023, film 4). The three later films keep their real titles and release dates and are now sequels to the 2009 film.

Phase One — 7 films

#	Film	US release	Notes
1	*Iron Man*	May 2, 2008	Paramount
2	*The Incredible Hulk*	June 13, 2008	Universal
3	***Ant-Man***	**2009 (date TBD)**	**NEW** — Ant-Man 1. Hank Pym and Janet van Dyne. Paramount.
4	*Iron Man 2*	May 7, 2010	Don Cheadle replaces Terrence Howard as Rhodey
5	*Thor*	May 6, 2011	
6	*Captain America: The First Avenger*	July 22, 2011	
7	*The Avengers*	May 4, 2012	The founding five assemble; Cap is found in the ice

Phase Two — 6 films

#	Film	US release	Notes
8	*Iron Man 3*	May 3, 2013	
9	*Thor: The Dark World*	Nov 8, 2013	
10	*Captain America: The Winter Soldier*	Apr 4, 2014	
11	*Guardians of the Galaxy*	Aug 1, 2014	
12	*Avengers: Age of Ultron*	May 1, 2015	Ends with Cap's Kooky Quartet as the new lineup
13	*Ant-Man*	July 17, 2015	**Ant-Man 2.** Scott Lang (Paul Rudd) becomes the second Ant-Man

Phase Three — 11 films

#	Film	US release	Notes
14	*Captain America: Civil War*	May 6, 2016	
15	*Doctor Strange*	Nov 4, 2016	
16	*Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 2*	May 5, 2017	
17	*Spider-Man: Homecoming*	July 7, 2017	Co-produced with Sony
18	*Thor: Ragnarok*	Nov 3, 2017	
19	*Black Panther*	Feb 16, 2018	
20	*Avengers: Infinity War*	Apr 27, 2018	

#	Film	US release	Notes
21	*Ant-Man and the Wasp*	July 6, 2018	**Ant-Man 3**
22	*Captain Marvel*	Mar 8, 2019	
23	*Avengers: Endgame*	Apr 26, 2019	
24	*Spider-Man: Far From Home*	July 2, 2019	Co-produced with Sony

Phase Four — 7 films

#	Film	US release	Notes
25	*Black Widow*	July 9, 2021	
26	*Shang-Chi and the Legend of the Ten Rings*	Sept 3, 2021	
27	*Eternals*	Nov 5, 2021	
28	*Spider-Man: No Way Home*	Dec 17, 2021	Co-produced with Sony
29	*Doctor Strange in the Multiverse of Madness*	May 6, 2022	
30	*Thor: Love and Thunder*	July 8, 2022	
31	*Black Panther: Wakanda Forever*	Nov 11, 2022	

Phase Five — 6 films

#	Film	US release	Notes
32	*Ant-Man and the Wasp: Quantumania*	Feb 17, 2023	**Ant-Man 4**
33	*Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 3*	May 5, 2023	
34	*The Marvels*	Nov 10, 2023	
35	*Deadpool & Wolverine*	July 26, 2024	
36	*Captain America: Brave New World*	Feb 14, 2025	
37	*Thunderbolts**	May 2, 2025	

Phase Six (in progress)

#	Film	US release	Notes
38	*The Fantastic Four: First Steps*	July 25, 2025	
39	*Spider-Man: Brand New Day*	July 31, 2026	Co-produced with Sony
40	*Avengers: Doomsday*	Dec 18, 2026	Scheduled
41	*Avengers: Secret Wars*	Dec 17, 2027	Scheduled

Phase Six follows the real schedule and will be updated as the real slate changes. TV, Disney+ series and specials will be covered in a separate volume.

2009 *Ant-Man*: Open Questions

#	Question	Recommendation
1	Release date	**Friday, July 31, 2009.** It's a quiet weekend, after *Harry Potter and the Half-Blood Prince* (July 15) and a week before *G.I. Joe* (August 7). It also lands one month before Disney's real announcement that it's buying Marvel on August 31, 2009, which makes the opening weekend a big storyline in the real-world story. The other option is Fox's *X-Men Origins: Wolverine* weekend (May 1, 2009) for a head-to-head rivalry storyline.
2	Director	**Edgar Wright** (born April 18, 1974; 32 today). In real life he and Joe Cornish had been developing *Ant-Man* since 2003, and Marvel officially named him director in 2006. In our story his film gets made first. His real 2014 exit from the 2015 film can then play out as the drama it really was, with Peyton Reed taking over film 2.
3	The Ant-Man handoff in 2015	In the comics, Hank Pym changes identities: Giant-Man in 1963, then Goliath and Yellowjacket. In 2015, Hank moves on to one of those identities and Scott Lang (Paul Rudd) inherits the Ant-Man suit. That keeps the 2015 film's real story and stays comic-accurate.
4	Who is the Wasp in films 3 and 4	**Janet van Dyne stays the Wasp**, as a founding Avenger. Whether Hope van Dyne (Evangeline Lilly) appears as Hank and Janet's daughter depends on your fictional actors' ages. We decide once you've created them.

Hank Pym and Janet van Dyne in Phase One

Recommended appearances before *The Avengers* (May 4, 2012), **pending your confirmation**. The goal is the same build-up Tony Stark got: introduced, recruited, and woven into the shared world so audiences already know them when the founding five assemble.

Film	Appearance	What happens
Iron Man May 2, 2008	Janet: cameo Hank: mentioned	Janet van Dyne, a socialite heiress and fashion designer just as in the comics, banters with Tony at the Firefighters' Family Fund gala. She mentions "a scientist boyfriend you'd hate." That introduces her a year before her own film.
The Incredible Hulk June 13, 2008	Hank: mentioned	General Ross's files show that Dr. Henry Pym turned down an offer to weaponize his research for the military's super-soldier work. That sets up Hank's principles and his distrust of Ross. (Universal distributes this film, so a reference is enough.)
Ant-Man 2009	**Lead roles**	Their own origin film. Janet becomes the Wasp. In the post-credits scene, Nick Fury approaches them about the Avengers Initiative, mirroring Tony's scene at the end of *Iron Man*.
Iron Man 2 May 7, 2010	**Supporting roles** (several scenes)	Hank and Janet attend the Stark Expo as Avengers Initiative candidates. Tony and Hank have a science rivalry scene, which plants the friction that pays off later (see Ultron below). The Wasp has a short action beat in the Expo drone battle. Fury's and Natasha's evaluations of the candidates include them.
Thor May 6, 2011	Easter egg only	S.H.I.E.L.D. uses equipment shrunk with Pym Particles at the Mjolnir crash site. Hank and Janet don't appear, so Thor's introduction stays focused on her.
Captain America: The First Avenger July 22, 2011	None	This film stays a pure WWII story that ends with Steve frozen in the ice. Hank and Janet are part of the team that finds him in *The Avengers*.

Planting Ultron, comic-accurately: in the comics, **Hank Pym creates Ultron** (*The Avengers* #54-55, 1968), and Ultron then builds the Vision. In *Avengers: Age of Ultron* (2015), Ultron is Hank's creation, not Tony's. Hank's guilt over it leads him to give up the Ant-Man suit, which is how Scott Lang inherits it in *Ant-Man* (July 17, 2015). The Tony-Hank rivalry in *Iron Man 2* is the first step on that road.